What this workbook covers 本册讲什么

A phobia is a **learned** fear — so it can be **unlearned**. This booklet walks through Wolpe's systematic desensitisation: the one rule it depends on, the five steps it follows, the evidence (Capafons et al., 1998), and the evaluation you need for 8-mark questions.

How to use this booklet 怎么用

1. **Fill it in as you go** — check the answer key (pp. 19–20) after each page.
2. **Pages 5–8 (the method) and 11 (the study) matter most.** Redo them from memory, under time.

Content map 内容地图

Page	Topic	What you must be able to do afterwards
p.2	Why "calm down" never works 引入	Explain that a phobia is a response, not a belief
p.3–4	Two distinctions + definition 概念与定义	Classify any therapy; unpack the name; Wolpe · 1950s · classical
p.5	Reciprocal inhibition 交互抑制	State the one rule and why it forces the order of the steps
p.6–8	The method: five steps + hierarchy 方法	Reproduce all five in order; build a hierarchy; two client rules
p.9–10	Exposure & relaxation 暴露与放松	In vivo / in vitro / VR; three relaxation methods
p.11	Capafons et al. (1998) 证据	Reproduce 41 / 20 / 21 / 18 and judge what it shows
p.12	Why it works 机制	Describe counterconditioning in CS/UCS language
p.13–15	Evaluation 评价	Four strengths, four limitations, each with a reason
p.16–17	Apps + exam skills 应用与技巧	Weigh VR delivery; differentiate the 4-mark "how" from the 8-mark "discuss"
p.18	Practice 演练	Plan and write the Judith 8-marker
p.19–20	Answer key 答案速查	Mark honestly, then re-write wrong answers in full

Revision tracker 复习打卡

☐ p.4 definition ☐ p.5 the one rule ☐ p.6–8 the method ☐ p.11 Capafons ☐ p.13–15 evaluation ☐ p.17–18 exam

The whole therapy in one sentence 一句话总结

Because **you cannot be anxious and relaxed at the same time** (reciprocal inhibition), a client who builds a **hierarchy of fears** with the therapist, learns **relaxation**, and climbs one rung at a time will — through **counterconditioning** — replace the learned fear with calm: 18 of Capafons et al.'s (1998) 20 flying-phobia clients did exactly that.

1 · Why "calm down" never works

The puzzle 引入

A friend freezes when a spider appears. You say: "*It's tiny. It can't hurt you.*" It never works.

Fill the gap 填空

The fear is not a **bel** _____ you can argue with. It is a **resp** _____ — the body has learned to react before the thinking brain gets a vote.

The question this chapter answers 本章核心问题

If fear can be **learned**, can it also be **u** _____ ? And how would you teach a body to unlearn something it has practised for years?

Quick check 快问快答

A therapist wants to cure a spider phobia. Which is closest to what systematic desensitisation does — (a) explaining why spiders are harmless, (b) pairing the feared object with an incompatible state, or (c) avoiding spiders until the fear fades?

中文理解 为什么「别怕」没有用

恐惧症（phobia）不是观点，是**条件反射**：身体比思考快一步。所以治疗不能靠讲道理，而要**重新训练反射**——让「蜘蛛」这个信号慢慢和「放松」而不是「恐惧」连在一起。

2 · Two distinctions you will reuse all topic

Distinction one 之一

Category	Works through	Examples
Psychological therapies	The mind — talking, learning, thinking, behaving	Psychoanalysis, behavioural, cognitive, family, humanistic
Biological treatments	_____	Medication, _____

Distinction two 之二

Key term

Directive therapy（指导性治疗） — the therapist _____ the client to do certain things or think in a different way.

Non-directive therapy（非指导性治疗） — the therapy makes sense of the client's _____ and how the client understands themselves.

Place the therapies 放置练习

Therapy	Directive?	Psychological or biological?
Systematic desensitisation		
Psychoanalysis (preview of 4.1.6)		
Antidepressant medication		

中文理解 指导性 vs 非指导性
Directive＝教练型：教练告诉你下一步做什么。SD 就是这样。
Non-directive＝陪聊型：来访者自由说，治疗师负责理解与解释。4.1.6 的精神分析就是这种。
考试常考「这个疗法是指导性还是非指导性」——记住：**只有 SD 是指导性**。

3 · What systematic desensitisation is

Key term — learn this word for word

Systematic desensitisation: a directive treatment typically used to treat _____ disorders, such as phobias, developed by _____ in the 19__0s and based on the principles of _____ conditioning.

The name says it all 名字拆解

Word	Meaning	In therapy
systematic	Gradually facing the phobic object via a _____ of exposure, from least fearful to most fearful	Nobody starts by holding a spider — start with a picture
desensitisation	Brought about by _____ techniques taught _____ facing the object	Relaxation must be available the moment fear appears

The logic in one sentence 一句话逻辑

Phobias are acquired through an unhelpful _____ response to a stimulus — so just as you can learn to fear something, you can _____ the fear by relaxing in contact with the phobic object.

中文理解 名字就是方法

systematic（系统的）＝按「恐惧等级表」一级一级来，不许跳级；**desensitisation**（脱敏）＝越来越「不敏感」，像打疫苗从小剂量开始。

一句话：**先练好放松，再按等级表一点点接近，直到害怕消失。**

4 · The one rule: reciprocal inhibition

Key term — the engine of the whole therapy

Reciprocal inhibition（交互抑制）: you cannot be _____ and _____ at the same time.

Draw it 画一画

Sketch the balance beam: one side ANXIETY (fast heart rate, tension), the other RELAXATION (slow breathing, loose muscles). Label which side goes down when the other goes up.

Why the order of the therapy follows from the rule 顺序问题

If the client meets the spider first and learns relaxation afterwards, why will the technique fail?

中文理解 为什么「同时」这么关键

紧张和放松不能同时全开。手上已经握着一杯水，就没办法同时握拳。

治疗师要做的是**先让你学会「握水杯」（放松），再把你带到害怕的东西面前**。放松必须像灭火器——火灾发生前就备好。

5 · The five steps (part one)

Steps 1–2 前两步

Step	What happens	Key detail
1. Functional analysis **（功能分析）**	A conversation between therapist and client to identify the _____ of the anxiety and the possible _____.	What exactly is feared? When? What makes it worse?
2. Develop a hierarchy of fears **（恐惧等级表）**	Client and therapist build a list from the _____ anxiety-provoking situation to the _____.	The client has _____ here — they know which rung feels worse.

Your own hierarchy 自己排一次

Bird phobia: write four situations from least to most anxiety-provoking. (Textbook example: 'thinking about a bird' → 'seeing a picture of a bird' → 'being in the same room as a bird in a cage' → …)

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5 · The five steps (part two)

Steps 3–5 后三步

Step	What happens	Key detail
3. Relaxation training **（放松训练）**	The client is taught how to relax using methods that _____ them best.	Deep breathing · progressive muscle relaxation · _____ (imagining a peaceful setting)
4. Gradual exposure **（渐进暴露）**	Working through the agreed hierarchy, the phobic object is introduced _____.	The therapist always works at the speed agreed by the _____.
5. Counterconditioning **（反向条件化）**	Through repeated _____ of the feared stimulus with relaxation, the client learns to associate the feared stimulus with _____ rather than anxiety.	This is the result of the process — not an extra technique.

Self-test: put the five in order 排序自测

Relaxation training · Functional analysis · Gradual exposure · Counterconditioning · Hierarchy of fears

Order: _____ → _____ → _____ → _____ → _____

中文理解 五步＝问清楚 → 排队 → 学放松 → 一级级上 → 换掉旧反应
考试写「如何实施」时，用 *firstly / secondly / thirdly* 把五步串起来——课本明确提示：像报菜谱一样按顺序写，才拿满过程分。

6 · The hierarchy: two rules and a ladder

The textbook ladder（图 22.1）

Number these five situations from 1 (least fearful) to 5 (most fearful):

- ____ Hold the spider
- ____ Look at a picture of the spider in a book
- ____ Be in the same room as the spider
- ____ Imagine the spider on your hand
- ____ Walk towards the spider

The two client-control rules 两条来访者规则

Rule	Why it matters
The client writes the rungs	Only the client knows which situation feels worse; an imposed order can push them up too early and _____ the fear.
The client sets the speed	Progress depends on the strength of the phobia and the client's ability to _____ — so the number of sessions varies.

中文理解 等级表为什么必须由来访者排

「怕」是主观的：治疗师觉得看照片很轻，来访者可能连照片都不敢看。排错等级＝把人推到承受不了的那一级，恐惧反而被强化（二次创伤）。等级表既是技术工具，也是**伦理保护**。

7 · In vivo or in vitro

Two forms of exposure 两种暴露

Form	What the client meets	Strength / weakness
in vivo **（真实暴露）**	The _____ object, in real life.	Stronger learning; harder to arrange and more frightening.
in vitro **（想象暴露）**	An _____ exposure — picturing the object or watching a film of it.	Safe and easy to control; learning may not _____ to the real situation.

The third route: virtual reality 第三条路

Modern practice adds VR: a headset places the client in a plane cabin or a spider room while the therapist controls exactly _____ appears and _____. It keeps the graded control of in vitro but feels closer to in vivo.

Memory hook 记忆钩子

vivo 有「活」的意思 → in vivo = 活的、真的（真蜘蛛）；in vitro = 在玻璃器皿里 = 想象或影像。

Quick check 快问快答

A client first imagines holding a spider, then later holds a real one. Which sessions were in vitro, and which were in vivo?

8 · Relaxation training

Three methods 三种方法

Method	How it works	Best for
Deep breathing	Slow abdominal breathing lowers _____ rate.	Useable in the moment, anywhere
Progressive muscle relaxation	Tensing then _____ each muscle group, teaching the difference between tension and relaxation.	Clients who respond to body work
Visualisation	Imagining a _____ setting until the image itself triggers calm.	Visually imaginative clients

Why practice beats instruction 为什么要练

A client uses a relaxation technique for the first time while facing a real spider — and it fails. Why?

The sentence to remember 背这句

Under fear, the body reverts to whatever it has **practised** — so relaxation must be automatic before exposure begins, or there is nothing to compete with the anxiety response.

9 · Evidence: Capafons et al. (1998)

The numbers 数字收口

Feature	Detail
Sample	_____ Spanish participants with a fear of _____ (aerophobia)
Treatment group	_____ participants treated with systematic desensitisation
Control group	_____ in a _____ control group (waiting for therapy, not yet treated)
Result	_____ of the treated participants reported lower levels of fear and were less _____

Read the result carefully 精读结论

Why does this study support the therapy — and what are three things it does NOT prove? (Hint: waiting control is not placebo; self-report is not behaviour; no long follow-up.)

中文理解 这组数据怎么用

41 人、20 人治疗、21 人等待、18 人好转——**支持「有效」**（AO3 的 strength）。

但要会挑毛病：等待对照组≠安慰剂组；结果是**自评**不是真去坐飞机；样本小；无长期追踪。先支持再限制＝8 分题高分结构。

10 · Why it works: conditioning in plain words

Fill the conditioning table 条件反射对照表

Term	In the phobia	In the therapy
CS	The _____ — a signal for danger.	Still the spider — but now paired with something new.
UCS / UCR	A frightening experience producing _____.	Relaxation training produces _____, deliberately.
New pairing	—	CS (spider) + _____, repeated at each rung.
New CR	Fear at the sight of the spider.	_____ at the sight of the spider — a counter-conditioned response.

Counterconditioning or extinction? 辨析

Extinction would present the spider repeatedly without anything unpleasant until the fear fades. How is counterconditioning more active than that?

The sentence to remember 背这句

Counterconditioning does not erase the old response — it attaches a **competing** response to the old stimulus, and because the two responses **inhibit each other**, the old one cannot run.

11 · Evaluation: strengths 1 and 2

Strength 1 — proven effectiveness 有效性

Most studies report that individuals receiving systematic desensitisation improve more than a _____ group. The behavioural outcome is _____ — you can see whether the client now approaches the spider.

Strength 2 — time and effort 省时省力

Compared with therapies that run for _____, SD is brief and _____ — the hierarchy gives a clear plan, progress is visible session by session, and that makes it cheaper for health services.

Turn each into an exam sentence 变成考试句子

Point → because → evidence:

AO3 模板

"SD has proven effectiveness: **most studies** show improvement greater than a non-treatment group — for example **Capafons et al. (1998)**, where 18 of 20 flying-phobia clients reported lower fear, against a waiting control group."

Strength 3 — self-administration 可自助

Because the method is a set of explicit steps, it can be delivered through _____ such as apps or _____ software. That widens access for people who cannot travel, cannot afford a therapist, or feel too ashamed to seek one.

Strength 4 — few ethical issues 伦理风险低

The techniques — the fear _____ and _____ techniques — ensure the client is **not exposed to any high-anxiety situation**. There is no deception and the client controls the pace. Compare flooding, which deliberately puts the client in the most frightening situation at once.

中文理解 为什么「伦理风险低」是加分点

同属行为疗法的 flooding（满灌疗法）直接把人放进最害怕的情境，效果快但可能造成创伤。SD 的等级表相当于**安全绳**。写「ethical」时必须说清**为什么**（等级表＋放松保证不进入高焦虑），否则是空话。

Four limitations 四条限制

Limitation	The reason behind it
1. Only some anxiety disorders	The object must be clearly _____ for a hierarchy to be built — so it is inappropriate for _____ anxiety disorder, where the anxiety spreads across many situations.
2. Evolutionary fears resist it	Phobias with a survival component — the dark, dangerous animals, heights — may be _____-rooted; they once kept our ancestors alive, so they are very difficult to remove.
3. Symptom, not cause	SD changes the _____ and says nothing about why the fear arose; if the phobia expresses an unresolved conflict, the anxiety may reappear in another form.
4. Depends on client skills	The client must be able to _____ on cue and tolerate exposure; self-help apps remove the therapist's judgement about when to stop.

中文理解 三个限制其实是一条逻辑

SD 要求「具体、可分级、可接近的恐惧对象」：对象不明确（GAD）＝做不出等级表；对象是进化写进基因的＝等级表压不住；恐惧只是更深问题的表面＝治好表面里面还在。

Both sides of the app 两边都说

Question	Case for the app	Case against the app
Access	No waiting list, no travel, available whenever the fear is worst.	Assumes a smartphone, data and privacy — _____ some who need it most.
Cost	A fraction of weekly sessions; scalable for health services.	Cheap partly because nobody is _____ the client.
Control	The client moves at their own pace — fitting the principle that the client sets the speed.	No therapist to judge when the client is climbing too _____.
Safety	In vitro and VR exposure cannot put the client in real danger.	Drop-out is _____; an abandoned programme gets no follow-up.

The judgement to reach 结论怎么下

Apps are a reasonable **first step or top-up** for mild, _____ phobias with a motivated client. They are a poor substitute for a therapist when the phobia is _____, when the client cannot relax, or when the fear is tangled up with other problems.

14 · Exam skills: the two command words

Two commands, two jobs 两种问法

Command	What you must do	Structure
Explain how… **(4 marks)**	Describe the _____, in order. AO1 only.	Firstly… (functional analysis) Secondly… (hierarchy) Thirdly… (relaxation) Finally… (graded exposure → counterconditioning)
Discuss… **(8 marks)**	Explain the therapy _____ evaluate it. AO1 4 + AO3 4.	AO1: what, how, mechanism. AO3: effectiveness + named study, then limitations (GAD, evolutionary fears).

Exam tip（课本原话改编）

When asked to explain or discuss **how** a therapy is conducted, treat it like a **recipe**: the examiner wants the steps. Framing with *firstly, secondly, thirdly* makes sure you write enough points.

Build your 8-mark skeleton 搭骨架

AO1: definition → functional analysis → hierarchy → relaxation → graded exposure → counterconditioning (reciprocal inhibition).

AO3: effectiveness (Capafons, 18/20) → brief, ethical, app-deliverable → but GAD cannot be treated → evolutionary fears resist → treats symptom not cause.

15 · Practice: the Judith question (8 marks)

Judith has developed a phobia of cats following an incident where a cat unexpectedly jumped out at her and bit her hand. Discuss systematic desensitisation as a treatment for Judith's phobia of cats. (8 marks)

Plan first — link every AO1 point to Judith 先列提纲

AO1 step	Applied to Judith, in your words
Functional analysis	
Hierarchy (name three rungs)	
Relaxation training	
Graded exposure + counterconditioning	

AO3 point	Linked to Judith
Strength with evidence	
Limitation	

Now write it 写正文

p.2 引入

belief · response. Quick check: (b) — the therapy pairs the feared object with an incompatible state (relaxation); explaining targets thoughts and avoidance makes fear worse.

p.3 两对概念

Biological treatments work through the body; examples: medication, psychosurgery. Directive = instructs; non-directive = makes sense of the client's experiences. SD: directive, psychological. Psychoanalysis: non-directive, psychological. Medication: (not directive — biological treatment), biological.

p.4 定义

anxiety disorders; Joseph Wolpe; 1950s; classical. systematic = gradually facing the object via a hierarchy of exposure (least → most fearful); desensitisation = brought about by relaxation techniques taught before facing the object. Logic: unhelpful learned response → you can unlearn the fear.

p.5 交互抑制

anxious / relaxed. Order question: because relaxation must already be present to inhibit the fear — if fear comes first there is nothing to inhibit it, and the fear is (at best) unchanged or reinforced. Relaxation must be automatic before exposure.

p.6 五步 1–2

nature of the anxiety; possible triggers. hierarchy: least → most. Key detail: client input (client knows which rung feels worse). Bird example order: thinking about a bird → seeing a picture → same room as a caged bird → (e.g.) bird in the garden → holding the bird.

p.7 五步 3–5

suit them best; visualisation. gradually; client. pairings; relaxation. Order: functional analysis → hierarchy of fears → relaxation training → gradual exposure → counterconditioning.

p.8 等级表

Numbering: 1 imagine the spider on your hand · 2 look at a picture in a book · 3 be in the same room · 4 walk towards the spider · 5 hold the spider. Rules: reinforced (too early exposure strengthens fear); relax.

p.9 in vivo / in vitro

real; imaginary; transfer. VR: what appears and when. Quick check: imagining = in vitro; holding the real spider = in vivo.

p.10 放松训练

heart; releasing; peaceful. Why it fails: under fear the body reverts to whatever it has practised — a technique used for the first time under threat is not automatic, so it cannot compete with the anxiety response.

p.11 Capafons et al. (1998)

41; flying. 20; 21, waiting; 18, anxious. What it shows: SD beats no treatment in a clinical phobia. What it does not prove: placebo effects (waiting control ≠ placebo), behaviour change (self-report only, not boarding a plane), long-term maintenance (no follow-up).

p.12 机制

spider; fear; calm. New pairing: relaxation. New CR: calm. Counterconditioning vs extinction: it attaches a competing response (relaxation) to the CS rather than merely repeating the CS without consequence — the two responses inhibit each other, so the old one cannot run.

p.13–14 优点

non-treatment group; measurable. years; structured. computer simulations; virtual reality. hierarchy; relaxation. Full sentences on p.13–14 boxes.

p.15 缺点

identifiable; generalised. evolution(ary). response; relax. Each needs its reason: GAD has no single object → no hierarchy; survival fears are deep-rooted and hard to remove; treating the response leaves causes untouched; relaxation ability varies.

p.16 app

excludes; assessing; fast; invisible. Judgement: good first step / top-up for mild, specific phobias; poor substitute when severe, when the client cannot relax, or when fear is tangled with other problems.

p.17 答题

process; and. The 8-marker: AO1 definition + five steps applied to the client; AO3 Capafons 18/20 + strengths/limits. See pp.13–15 for full sentences.

Final check · brain dump 五分钟默检

No notes. Write: (1) the definition of reciprocal inhibition; (2) the five steps in order; (3) the two client-control rules of the hierarchy; (4) Capafons numbers; (5) one strength + its reason; (6) one limitation + its reason.

Last thing 下一步

Done with 4.1.5? Move to **4.1.6 Psychoanalysis and the object relations school** — the non-directive mirror image of this therapy.